Blue in the Face

By Kayla Cagan

ANDREW: Cold.

MARION: Colder.

ANDREW: Freezing.

MARION: Iceberg.

INTRODUCTION

ANDREW: Not the temperature changing as you go North.
MARION: Not the water as you get further out to sea.
BOTH: A relationship.
ANDREW: After it's over…
MARION: You can only talk about it for so long before you're both…
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ANDREW: Well, if it isn't the patron saint of [jerks].

MARION: Guess what I did today.

ANDREW: You sat and pondered your next great masterpiece.

MARION: Guess again.

ANDREW: Man, I never guess right. Hhmmm...

MARION: Never. You're not even close to warm.

ANDREW: Cold.

MARION: Colder.

ANDREW: Freezing.

MARION: You are an iceberg. *(Long pause.)*

ANDREW: Thanks for the keys.

MARION: You're all set.

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ANDREW: I appreciate you lending me *your* place.

MARION: *My* space.

ANDREW: You mind if I get a brewski?

MARION: Why should I mind now? I'll get it for you. *(She exits. As she re-enters, she holds the cans behind her back.)* Guess.

ANDREW: Right hand.

MARION: Guess again.

ANDREW: Other right hand.

MARION: Guess again.

ANDREW: Left foot.

MARION: Guess again. *(Andrew moves toward Marion. They are close to kissing, but don't.)*

ANDREW: I don't think I need to guess anymore.

MARION: You never figured out what I did today. *(He takes the beer from her and begins to drink.)*

ANDREW: *(Sighs.)* Did not.

MARION: So ...

ANDREW: So.

MARION: Aren't you the least bit--

ANDREW: Why should I care what you do anymore? You kicked me out!

MARION: Out of the apartment.

ANDREW AND MARION: But not out of your/my life. *(Pause)*

MARION: I'll tell you what I did today.

ANDREW: I've got Beannie in the car, if this is going to be a while. I just came

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by to get the--

MARION: You have Beannie in the car? Why didn't you tell me? Why didn't you bring her in?

ANDREW: I didn't want to confuse her.

MARION: I'll bring her some water.

ANDREW: She has water, and her chew, and her bone. She's fine. You'll see her on the weekend.

MARION: I'm still her mommy.

ANDREW: No, you aren't. You are her "weekends only" mommy, her "only when things are fun" mommy. I'm the one who walks her every morning. I'm the one cleaning up her crap.

MARION: Yeah, I'm really glad she doesn't crap on Saturday and Sunday. That would suck.

ANDREW: Well, thanks for the keys and letting me use the place. I should be--

MARION: What? Before this turns ugly?

ANDREW: Thank God we were never married. *(Pause)*

MARION: Do you hate me yet?

ANDREW: How am I supposed to answer that?

MARION: Well, I have an answer for you. *(She raises her shirt to show off a new, swelling belly ring.)* How's this? *(She prances.)*

ANDREW: Oh.

MARION: That's all you can say?

ANDREW: Yes.

MARION: I thought…

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ANDREW: You thought what? I'd appreciate that!

MARION: I thought it would make you laugh.

ANDREW: For three years I asked you to get it pierced. Two months after we break up--

MARION: I finally followed your advice! Irony! Get it?!?!

ANDREW: You must be pleased.

MARION: No, I'm just a bitch.

ANDREW: Yes, you are. *(Pause')* Can I touch it? *(She nods. He goes to her and touches her belly.)*

MARION: Be careful! It hurts like hell. It stings. Your hands are cold!

ANDREW: It's turning blue, kind of pinkish blue/

MARION: A bruise.

ANDREW: So, why'd you do it? You want to tell me anyway, right, so ...

MARION: Listen, I'm letting you borrow this place of *ours* and I'm letting you have the extra keys again, so--

ANDREW: *(He grabs her by the hips.)* What the hell is this, Marion? *(Long pause.)*

MARION: Do you want to hear how it happened or don't you?

ANDREW: What choice do I have?

MARION: I didn't go to Bloomingdale's to get it done. I went to a little cosmetology school down in the Bowery. I thought they would be careful, clean, cautious, considerate…

ANDREW: Catatonic!

MARION: I was held down in this barber chair. My jeans were unbuttoned, my shirt was untied, and I felt four clumsy hands on me, all students, push-

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ing and pulling my skin and then there was this little plastic gun. I told them I was changing my mind, I was frightened, there wasn't even any ice, I thought there would be ice.

ANDREW: You weren't, raped, you know.

MARION: I did this for you.

ANDREW: Did you rehearse this? You're really being weird. *(Marion stares at Andrew.)*

MARION: I saw myself hanging upside down in a mirror on the wall behind the students. I turned blue for you. My eyes turned purple and my cheeks filled like plums and my lips were numb and cold and greenish and when I thought I was going to be sick! *(Marion runs to the sink and throws up. Andrew flinches.)*

MARION: I went cold.

ANDREW: Colder.

MARION: Freezing.

ANDREW: You were an iceberg.

MARION: I went numb because of you, I went cold, I went blue.

ANDREW: But you are here now. And your stomach looks so ...

MARION: I don't feel well.

ANDREW: Let me see your stomach again.

MARION: Be careful. *(She lifts her shirt.)*

ANDREW: For Christ's sakes, Marion, it's turning gray.

MARION: They said I had to clean it with peroxide twice daily, like when you get your ears pierced.

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ANDREW: I've never had my ears pierced.

MARION: Not now, please.

ANDREW: You need to get this thing out of you. Go in the bathroom and get a cold rag.

MARION: It's Florence Nightingale!

ANDREW: I'm trying to help you! I'm not the one puking my guts out while my abdomen is bloating into the Good Year Blimp. Now shut your mouth and help me!

MARION: No way.

ANDREW: Same old Marion.

MARION: I want it now! I'm not taking it out.

ANDREW: Yeah, Marion, you are.

MARION: No, I'm not! *(Andrew grabs Marion and throws her on the couch. He straddles her, trying to pin her down so that he can reach her stomach without a fight. Marion scratches him.)*

ANDREW: Let me!

MARION: Get your hands--

ANDREW: What? What is it? WHAT THE HELL DO YOU WANT, MARION?

(Andrew gets off of her. They sit on the couch, panting.)

ANDREW: I came to get the keys. That's all I wanted.

MARION: Well, you got what you wanted the minute you walked **in** the door. Why did you stay?

ANDREW: Why do I always stay, Marion?

MARION: You should go.

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ANDREW: I should. *(Pause)*

ANDREW: Beannie needs me. Beannie is out **in** the car.

MARION: I know she *is!*

ANDREW: I'm sorry you are *so…*

MARION: Cold?

ANDREW: I'll bring Beannie by on

ANDREW AND MARION: Friday. *(Andrew takes one last sip of beer and exits. Marion picks up her beer, takes a swig. She starts to pull at her ring, but it hurts too much. She lightly taps the can against her belly, softly repeating* "Cold, colder, freezing, iceberg." *Lights fade as Marion passes out on the couch.)*

SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Kayla Cagan
Book: The Best Ten-Minute Plays for Two Actors 2006
ISBN: 978-1575255637
Publisher: Smith & Kraus Inc.
Date (Month/Year): November 2007

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